



### Rare blooms

The Atacama Desert is the driest place on Earth. It rains here only every six years or so, but when it does, seeds in the sand quickly germinate into blankets of colorful flowers.

### Easter Island

This remote volcanic island is known as Rapa Nui by its inhabitants.



### Mapuche people

About 10 percent of the Chilean population is indigenous Mapuche people. They make beautiful handcrafted textiles, including ponchos, to sell.



# Chile



### Paranal Observatory

Located in the Atacama Desert, this observatory has some of the world's most powerful telescopes for observing the night sky.



### Underground snack

Meaning "stony ground," this traditional Chilean dish of meat, fish, and vegetables is cooked on hot rocks inside a deep hole in the ground.

### High-life llamas

The llama is a popular pack animal in Chile also kept for its wool. This domesticated hardy creature is able to live at high altitudes.



### Stone statues

Chile's best-known landmarks are the stone figures of Easter Island. The moai (meaning "statues") were carved from about 1000 CE onward.



Stretching 2,670 miles (4,300 km), this South American nation is the world's **longest** and **thinnest** country. One side is bordered by the **Andes Mountains**, and the other is the **Pacific Ocean**, where **Easter Island** lies some 2,290 miles (3,680 km) away.



- 📏 291,933 sq miles (756,102 sq km)
- 👤 18.2 million
- ★ Santiago
- 🗣️ Spanish, Amerindian languages